



**ENGAGEMENT OF CONSULTANT
FOR SUBMISSION OF FEASIBILITY TARIFF REPORT FOR
TARIFF CALCULATION AND FINANCIAL MODELLING
METHODOLOGY**

NOTICE INVITING BID

DOMESTIC COMPETITIVE BIDDING (through e-Tender)

Tender No.CO CONTS/0027T/TC & FM_100 MW SPP/DCB/e-Conts/2025, Dt.29.10.2025.

1.0 INVITATION

Online Bids in English are invited by NLC India Limited (NLCIL), Neyveli on behalf of Coal Lignite Urja Vikas Private Limited (CLUVPL) for “Engagement of Consultancy Agency Services for Tariff Calculation and Financial Modelling for participating in a Renewable Energy (RE) tender of 100 MW Solar Power Project (SPP) with Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)”.

This Solar Project is intended to be developed by Coal Lignite Urja Vikas Private Limited (CLUVPL), which is a Joint Venture Company formed between NLC India Limited (NLCIL) and Coal India Limited (CIL) during November 2020.

Sl. No.	Description	Details
i)	NLCIL Tender No.	Tender No.CO CONTS/0027T/TC & FM_100 MW SPP/DCB/e-Conts/2025, Dt.29.10.2025.
ii)	Name of the Work	Engagement of Consultancy Agency Services for Tariff Calculation and Financial Modelling for 100MW SPP with BESS
iii)	Mode of Tender	DCB (e-Tendering – Two cover system)
iv)	Date of Pre bid meeting	06.11.2025 at 11.00 Hrs. through Video Conference
v)	Last Date & Time for submission of Online Bid	19.11.2025 at 14:30 Hrs.
vi)	Date & Time of opening of Part-I Online Bid	19.11.2025 at 15:00 Hrs.
vii)	Date of opening of Price cover (Part-II)	Will be intimated later.

Note:

1. The points for discussion in Pre-Bid meeting shall be furnished at least two days in advance to date of Pre-Bid meeting to the e-mail ID: corporate.conts@nlcindia.in.
2. Bidders who are interested to participate in the Pre-bid Meeting may send their request to corporate.conts@nlcindia.in furnishing Company name and address, Name of the



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authorized person to attend Pre-bid meeting, contact number and e-Mail ID to enable us to send the link for participating in the Pre-bid meeting.

3. For further details, please visit our website: www.nlcindia.in, NeAT portal: <https://procure.nlcindia.in> or Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP) of Government of India website: www.eprocure.gov.in or contact:

The General Manager/Contracts,
Corporate Office, NLC India Limited,
Block-1, Neyveli– 607 801.
Phone: 04142 – 212308/ 251620.
e-Mail: corporate.conts@nlcindia.in

2.0 SCOPE OF WORK:

The scope of consultant is mainly for determination of robust and adaptable Tariff Calculation & Financial Modelling for participating in a Renewable Energy (RE) tender of 100 MW Solar Power Project (SPP) with Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) with variable CUF and BESS capacity in either of any states (Tamil Nadu, Assam, Gujarat and Rajasthan) to ensure competitive and successful Bid submissions. The consultancy services will encompass, but not be limited to, the following tasks:

- i. Overall Site Assessment for setting up Project and its optimization as per provided site details (Desktop study).
- ii. Technology selection of solar plant component including BESS.
- iii. Solar PV capacity assessment including Annual Energy Production and conduct shading analysis and optimize layout for maximum energy yield.
- iv. Assess different BESS capacity /configuration.
- v. Capacity Utilization Factor (CUF) considering of 24%, 26%, 28% and 30%.
- vi. Assess different Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) cost of capacities 100 MWh, 200 MWh, 300 MWh, and 400 MWh by considering the CUF of each case as mentioned.
- vii. Basic concept design and selection of Technology & key components.
- viii. Statutory regulations, permits and clearance requirements.
- ix. Cost estimates and Financials.
 - a) Project cost estimates including major components based on recent market data.
 - b) Operation and maintenance costs
 - c) Contingency.
 - d) Develop a financial model, including assumptions (CAPEX, OPEX) and revenue projections
 - e) Calculate NPV, IRR, and other performance indicators to evaluate project viability.
 - f) Conduct sensitivity analysis to assess financial risks and mitigation strategies



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- g) Assess and address risks specific to Solar PV, and BESS components.
- h) Incentives and Subsidies (Government incentives, tax credits, and subsidies can significantly reduce the effective cost and thus the tariff).
- i) Determining the tariff cost per unit (kwh) considering the above points.
- x. Any other details as required by CLUVPL in relation to scope of services.
- xi. Consultancy agency should adhere the scope of services as per Time schedule.

3.0 QUALIFYING REQUIREMENTS (QR):

- 3.1 The bidder should possess Experience for working with Developers / EPC as an Engineering Consultant including tariff study for at least 1 [one] single location solar project of 30 MW capacity with BESS in India/Overseas as on the original scheduled date of Tender opening.

AND

- 3.2 The bidder should possess the experience of having successfully completed similar works during the last 7-years as on the original scheduled date of tender opening which should be anyone of the following:

- a) Three similar completed works of each costing not less than the amount equal to Rs.7,73,136/- (Incl. of GST)

OR

- b) Two similar completed works of each costing not less than the amount equal to Rs. 9,66,420/- (Incl. of GST)

OR

- c) One similar completed work costing not less than the amount equal to Rs.15,46,272/- (Incl.of GST)

“Similar Works” shall mean Experience for working with Developers / EPC as an Engineering Consultant including tariff study in Solar PV with BESS Project in India/Overseas.

Note: Works related to Lenders Independent Engineering or technical due diligence or Project Management consultant of projects shall not be considered as Similar Works.

3.3 Financial Criteria:

- a) The Bidder shall have Positive Net Worth as per the latest audited financial statements.
- b) The average annual financial turnover of the bidder during the last 3-years should be not less than or equal to Rs. 46,38,816/- as on the original scheduled date of tender opening.

4.0 Documentary Evidence for meeting the QR:

For QR 3.1: The bidder should submit Completion / Performance certificates and Letter of Award issued by Government Organizations/ Semi Government Organizations/ Public Sector Undertakings/ Autonomous bodies/ Municipal bodies/ Public Limited company for having successfully completed.



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For QR 3.2: The bidder should submit Completion certificates and Work Order in reference to Sl. No. (i. minimum 3 nos., ii. 2 nos. or iii.1 no. as the case may be) above issued by Government Organizations/ Semi Government Organizations/ Public Sector Undertakings/ Autonomous bodies/ Municipal bodies/ Private Limited Company/ Public Limited Company for having successfully completed similar works in the last 7 years as on the original scheduled date of tender opening.

For QR 3.3: Bidder shall furnish his audited profit and loss accounts and balance sheets for the last three (3) consecutive financial years as on the original scheduled date of tender opening.

Notes:

- i. In cases, where audited financial statement (Profit & Loss Account and Balance Sheet) for the last financial year immediately preceding the original schedule date of Tender opening are not available, a certificate would be required from the bidder stating that the Financial statement of the bidder are under audit as on the date of tender opening. In such case, the audited financial statement of three consecutive financial years preceding the last financial year shall be considered for evaluating the financial parameters.
- ii. In case, if a bidder meets the technical PQR but could not furnish his / their audited financial statement of three consecutive financial years preceding the last financial year for evaluating the average Annual turnover, due to the incorporation / formation of the bidder, with in a period of less than 3 years from the original scheduled date of tender opening, then, such bidder shall also be considered and the Average annual turnover of such bidder shall be arrived at as below:
 - a) If the bidder furnished audited financial statement (Profit & Loss Account and Balance Sheet) for the last financial year only, then such bidder's average Annual turnover shall be arrived at by dividing the Turnover of the last financial year by three.
 - b) If the bidder furnished audited financial statement (Profit & Loss Account and Balance Sheet) for the last two financial years only, then the bidder's average Annual turnover shall be arrived at by dividing the sum of Turnover of last two financial years by three.
- iii. NLCIL / CLUVPL reserves the right to ask the bidders to furnish the certified copies of experience certificates. For installation outside India, experience certificate issued by the end user firm shall be in English and is to be authenticated by the Indian Embassy in that country (or) Apostille in lieu of Embassy Authentication and if it is not in English, translated copy in English, is to be authenticated by the Indian Embassy in that country (or) Apostille in lieu of Embassy Authentication and within India experience certificate is to be attested by a Notary public.



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- iv. The purchaser also reserves the right to consider any foreign installations as experience, only if the Bidder facilitates necessary inspection of such installation by the purchaser. However, cost pertaining to the purchaser's personnel for such inspection shall be borne by the purchaser.
- v. The Bidder shall submit End User Certificate which is subject to verification for qualification. In case the bidder furnishes the end user certificates showing the experiences of their subsidiary or group companies or companies under the same Management, a confirmation from the firm which is having the experience in this regard is to be enclosed along with end user certificate. In case of end user certificates are furnished by the Bidder from the subsidiary or group companies or companies under the same Management, in addition to End User Confirmation, CLUVPL reserves the right to inspect such installations where such certificates are obtained by the Bidder, only if the Bidder facilitates necessary inspection of such installation by the purchaser. However, cost pertaining to the purchaser's personnel for such inspection shall be borne by the purchaser.
- vi. CLUVPL reserves the right to inspect the plant(s) referred to by the bidders as well as the original documents submitted in support of their claim to assess its veracity.

5.0 PUBLIC PROCUREMENT POLICY (PREFERENCE TO MAKE IN INDIA)

- 5.1 The bidder shall take note of the following as per Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (formerly, Department of Industry Policy and Promotion), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India, Public Procurement (Preference to Make in India) Order 2017 – Revision: Dt: 16.09.2020 & 19.07.2024 and confirm compliance to the requirements in this regard as indicated below:

5.1.1 DEFINITIONS:

- (i) 'Local content' means the amount of value added in India which shall, unless otherwise prescribed by the Nodal Ministry, be the total value of the item procured (excluding net domestic indirect taxes) minus the value of imported content in the item (including all customs duties) as a proportion of the total value, in percent.
- (ii) 'Class-I local supplier', means a supplier or service provider, whose goods, services or works offered for procurement, meets the minimum local content as prescribed for 'Class-I local supplier' under order dt. 16.09.2020 & 19.07.2024.
- (iii) 'Class-II local supplier' means a supplier or service provider, whose goods, services or works offered for procurement, meets the minimum local content as prescribed for 'Class-II local supplier' but less than that prescribed for 'Class-I local supplier' under order dt. 16.09.2020 & 19.07.2024.
- (iv) 'Non-Local Supplier' means a supplier or service provider whose goods, services or works offered for procurement has local content less than that prescribed for 'Class-II local supplier' under order dt. 16.09.2020 & 19.07.2024.
- (v) Minimum local content: The 'Local Content' requirement to categorize a supplier as 'Class-I Local Supplier' is minimum 50%. For 'Class – II Local Supplier', the 'Local Content' requirement is minimum 20%. For the items, for which Nodal



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Ministry Department has not prescribed higher minimum local content notification under the Order, it shall be 50% and 20% for Class – I local supplier / Class – II local supplier respectively.

- (vi) 'L1' means the lowest tender or lowest bid or the lowest quotation received in a tender, bidding process or other procurement solicitation as adjusted in the evaluation process as per the tender or other procurement solicitation.
- (vii) 'Margin of purchase preference' means the maximum extent to which the price quoted by a 'Class-I local supplier' may be above the L1 for the purpose of purchase preference.
- (viii) 'Nodal Ministry' means the Ministry of Department identified pursuant to this order in respect of a particular item of goods or services or works.
- (ix) 'Procuring entity' means a Ministry or department or attached or subordinate office of, or autonomous body controlled by the Government of India and includes Government companies as defined in the Companies Act.
- (x) 'Works' means all works as per Rule 130 of GFR-2017, and will also include 'turnkey works'.

5.1.2 ELIGIBILITY CLASS:

Only Class-I local supplier is eligible to participate in this Tender.

5.1.3 MARGIN OF PURCHASE PREFERENCE:

Not Applicable

5.1.4 Verification of local content:

- a. The 'Class-I local supplier' at the time of tender, bidding or solicitation shall be required to indicate percentage of local content and provide self-certification that the item offered meets the local content requirement for 'Class-I local supplier', as the case may be. They shall also give details of the location(s) at which the local value addition is made.
- b. In cases of procurement for a value in excess of Rs.10 crores, the 'Class-I local supplier' shall be required to provide a certificate from the statutory auditor or cost auditor of the company (in the case of companies) or from a practicing cost accountant or practicing chartered accountant (in respect of suppliers other than companies) giving the percentage of local content.
- c. The bidder shall give self-certification for local content in the quoted item (goods/works/services) at the time of tendering. However, at the time of execution of the project, for all contracts above INR 10 Crore, the Consultant/ supplier shall be required to give local content certification duly certified by cost/ chartered accountant in practice. For cases where it is not possible to provide certification by Cost/Chartered Accountant after completion of the contract, within time limit acceptable to the procuring entity. In case, the Consultant/ supplier does not meet the stipulated local content requirement and the category of the supplier changes from Class-I to Class-II/ Non-local or from Class-II to Non-local, a penalty up to 10% of



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the contract value may be imposed. However, contract once awarded shall not be terminated on this account.

- d. False declarations will be in breach of the Code of Integrity under Rule 175(1)(i)(h) of the General Financial Rules for which a bidder or its successors can be debarred for up to two years as per the Rule 151(iii) of the General Financial Rules along with such other actions as may be permissible under law.
- e. A supplier who has been debarred by any procuring entity for violation of this Order shall not be eligible for preference under this Order for procurement by any other procuring entity for the duration of the debarment. The debarment for such other procuring entities shall take effect prospectively from the date on which it comes to the notice of other procurement entities.

5.1.5 RECIPROCITY CLAUSE:

Entities of Countries which have been identified by the nodal Ministry / Department as not allowing Indian companies to participate in their Government procurement for any item related to that nodal Ministry shall not be allowed to participate in Government procurement in India for all items related to that nodal Ministry / Department, except for the list of items published by the Ministry / Department permitting their participation.

The term ‘entity’ of a country shall have the same meaning as under the FDI policy of DPIIT as amended from time to time.

5.2 Department of Expenditure Order (Public Procurement No.: 1) Order No.6/18/2019-PPD, Dt: 23.07.2020.

- I. Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance have issued Public Procurement No.: 4, Order No.: F.7/10/2021-PPD (1), Dt: 23.02.2023 in supersession to all of the above-mentioned Orders/clarifications, in which, the requirement of registration is stated as follows:

“Any bidder from a country which shares a land border with India will be eligible to bid in any procurement whether of goods, services (including consultancy services and non-consultancy services) or works (including turnkey projects) only if the bidder is registered with the specified Competent Authority.”

II. Definitions:

- a. “Bidder” (including the term ‘tenderer’, ‘consultant’ or ‘vendor’ or ‘service provider’ in certain contexts) means any person or firm or company, including any member of a consortium or joint venture (that is an association of several persons, or firms or companies), every artificial juridical person not falling in any of the descriptions of bidders stated hereinbefore, including any agency branch or office controlled by such person, participating in a procurement process.
 - b. “Tender” for the purpose of the Order will include other forms of procurement, except where the context requires otherwise.
- III. “Bidder (or entity) from a country which shares a land border with India” for the purpose of this Order means:



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- a. An entity incorporated, established or registered in such a country; or
- b. A subsidiary of an entity incorporated, established or registered in such a country; or
- c. An entity substantially controlled through entities incorporated, established or registered in such a country; or
- d. An entity whose beneficial owner is situated in such a country; or
- e. An Indian (or other) agent of such an entity; or
- f. A natural person who is a citizen of such a country; or
- g. A consortium or joint venture where any member of the consortium or joint venture falls under any of the above.

IV. The beneficial owner for the purpose of (iii) above will be as under:

1. In case of a company or Limited Liability Partnership, the beneficial owner is the natural person(s), who, whether acting alone or together, or through one or more juridical person(s), has a controlling ownership interest or who exercises control through other means

Explanation:

- a. "Controlling ownership interest" means ownership of, or entitlement to, more than twenty-five per cent of shares or capital or profits of the company.
- b. "Control" shall include the right to appoint majority of the directors or to control the management or policy decisions, including by virtue of their shareholding or management rights or shareholders agreements or voting agreements.
2. In case of a partnership firm, the beneficial owner is the natural person(s) who, whether acting alone or together, or through one or more juridical person, has ownership of entitlement to more than fifteen percent of capital or profits of the partnership.
3. In case of an unincorporated association or body of individuals, the beneficial owner is the natural person(s), who, whether acting alone or together; or through one or more juridical person, has ownership of or entitlement to more than fifteen percent of the property or capital or profits of such association or body of individuals.
4. Where no natural person is identified under (1) or (2) or (3) above, the beneficial owner is the relevant natural person who holds the position of senior managing official.
5. In case of a trust, the identification of beneficial owner(s) shall include identification of the author of the trust, the trustee, the beneficiaries with fifteen percent or more interest in the trust and any other natural person exercising ultimate effective control over the trust through a chain of control or ownership.

V. An Agent is a person employed to do any act for another, or to represent another in dealings with third persons.

Note:

- i. A person who procures and supplies finished goods from an entity from a country which shares a land border with India will, regardless of the nature of his legal



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- or commercial relationship with the producer of the goods, be deemed to be an Agent for the purpose of this Order.
- ii. However, a bidder who only procures raw material, components etc. from an entity from a country which shares a land border with India and then manufactures or converts them into other goods will not be treated as an Agent.
- VI. The successful bidder shall not be allowed to sub-contract works to any Consultant from a country which shares a land border with India unless such Consultant is registered with the Competent Authority.
- i. Bidder is permitted to procure raw material, components, sub-assemblies etc. from the vendors from countries which share a land border with India. Such vendors will not be required to be registered with the Competent Authority, as it is not regarded as “sub-contracting”.
- ii. However, in case a bidder has proposed to supply finished goods procured directly/indirectly from the vendors from the countries sharing land border with India, such vendor will be required to be registered with the Competent Authority.
- VII. Procurement of spare parts and other essential service support like Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC)/Comprehensive Maintenance Contract (CMC), including consumables for closed systems, from Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs) or their authorized agents, shall be exempted from the requirement of registration as mandated under Rule 144(xi) of GFRs 2017 and Public Procurement Orders issued in this regard.

5.2.1 Model Certificate:

“I have read the clause regarding restrictions on procurement from a bidder of a country which shares a land border with India; I certify that this bidder is not from such a country or, if from such a country has been registered with the Competent Authority. I hereby certify that this bidder fulfils all requirements in this regard and is eligible to be considered. [Where applicable, evidence of valid registration by the Competent Authority shall be attached].”

The above said order will not apply to bidders from those countries (even if sharing a land border with India) to which, Govt. of India has extended lines of credit or in which, and the Govt. of India is engaged in development projects (Order Public Procurement No.2)

Any bidder (including its Collaborator/Associate/JDU Partner/JV partner/ Consortium Member / Assignee, wherever applicable) from a country which shares a land border with India will be eligible to bid in this tender only if the bidder is registered with the Competent Authority. Such registration should be valid for the entire period of bid validity or any extension thereof. However, in case the validity period of registration is less than bid validity period, the Bidder shall be required to submit the extension of the validity period of registration before the opening of price bids, failing which the bid is liable for rejection.

6.0 Preference to MSE:

Purchase preference will be given to MSEs having valid Udyam Registration and whose credentials are validated online through Udyam Registration portal as defined in Public



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Procurement Policy for Micro and Small Enterprises (MSEs) Order, 2012 dated 23.03.2012 issued by Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises and its subsequent Orders/Notifications issued by concerned Ministry. If the bidder wants to avail themselves of the Purchase preference, the bidder must be the manufacturer / OEM of the offered product on GeM. Traders are excluded from the purview of Public Procurement Policy for Micro and Small Enterprises and hence resellers offering products manufactured by some other OEM are not eligible for any purchase preference. In respect of bid for Services, the bidder must be the Service provider of the offered Service. Relevant documentary evidence in this regard shall be uploaded along with the bid in respect of the offered product or service and Buyer will decide eligibility for purchase preference based on documentary evidence submitted, while evaluating the bid. If L1 is not an MSE and MSE Seller (s) has / have quoted price within L1+ 15% (Selected by Buyer) of margin of purchase preference /price band defined in relevant policy, such MSE Seller shall be given opportunity to match L1 price and Contract will be awarded for 100% (selected by Buyer) percentage of total quantity. The bidders are advised to refer the OM No. F.1/4/2021-PPD dated 18.05.2023 for compliance of Concurrent application of Public Procurement Policy for Micro and Small Enterprises Order, 2012 and Public Procurement (Preference to Make in India) Order, 2017 dt.16.09.2020 & 19.07.2024.

7.0 TIME SCHEDULE:

Sl.No.	Activity Details	Time Period
1	LOA / Work Order	Zero Date (D)
2	Data Collection & Desktop study	D+5 days
3	Hybrid System sizing	D+10 days
4	Submission of draft proposed planning report	D+15 days
5	Submission of Draft Feasibility Tariff Report	D+25 days
6	Furnishing CLUVPL Comments on draft feasibility Tariff report	D+35 days
7	Submission of Final Feasibility Tariff Report	D+45 days

8.0 Bid Submission & Opening:

- (i) All bids, including all attachments/enclosures shall be prepared in English Language only and submit the same. The bidder shall submit the offer for full scope of work indicated in the Tender Specification.



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Part - I & Part – II of the Bids are to be submitted through online.

(ii) The Offers/Bids are to be obtained in two Part system as detailed below:-

Part I	:	PART – I (through online) Covering Letter, Power of Attorney (Authorization with the seal of the company in favour of the person signing the Bid), Techno-Commercial details, duly filled up Checklist as in Specimen Format and all other details as given in the Tender document.
Part II	:	Part-II (Price) (through online) Price Bid with completely filled in Schedule of Prices (Schedule of Prices–F1) of the Tender document.

Note: Part-I shall be opened on the scheduled date of tender opening.

9.0 Special Note and Information Regarding the Tender

- (i) For downloading tender document, please visit our website: www.nlcindia.in or Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP) of Government of India, Website: www.eprocure.gov.in or NeAT Portal: <https://procure.nlcindia.in>
- (ii) Amendments/ Errata/ Clarifications if any, shall be issued as Corrigendum for the tender and shall form part and parcel of the tender documents. Corrigendum will be displayed in NLCIL's Website www.nlcindia.in / NLCIL NeAT Portal <https://procure.nlcindia.in> of /Central Public Procurement Portal (CPPP) of Government of India, (www.eprocure.gov.in). Bidders are requested to visit NLCIL's website or Central Public Procurement Portal. NLCIL / CLUVPL will not be responsible if any bidder omits to notice any Corrigendum. Corrigendum will be numbered consecutively. All the corrigendum issued are forming part and parcel of the tender documents.
- (iii) All other Terms and conditions, time schedule and Instructions to bidders are contained in the tender specification.
- (iv) NLCIL / CLUVPL reserves the right to accept/reject any bid or all bids received at its discretion without assigning any reason whatsoever thereof. No further correspondence shall be entertained in this regard.
- (v) The Bid shall be made in Indian Rupees only and all payments for the entire scope will be made in Indian Rupees.
- (vi) Bids submitted by fax or E-Mail or other than the prescribed mode of submission as per the tender shall be rejected.
- (vii) NLCIL takes no responsibility for delay or any letter sent by the Bidder.
- (viii) The Tender specifications are meant for the exclusive purpose of bidding against the subject package and shall not be transferred, reproduced or otherwise used for purposes other than for which these are specifically issued.
- (ix) Any bidder, who is placed under Suspension/Banning by NLCIL / CLUVPL will not be allowed to participate in any tender issued on or after the date of



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suspension/banning order and also if that bidder has already participated in any tender which is under process, their bid will not be considered for further processing.

- (x) Bidders are advised to quote the most competitive price, since there will not be post tendering negotiations with the lowest bidder.
- (xi) Bidders are permitted to furnish clarification/ deviation, if any during pre-bid stage only. Deviation requests of the bidders, only up to the pre-bid stage which are acceptable to NLCIL / CLUVPL will be communicated to the bidders for consideration.
- (xii) Bidders are not allowed to take any deviations in their bid. Deviations listed anywhere in the Bid shall not be considered.
- (xiii) In case of extension of Bid submission date, the Qualifying requirements met by the Bidder as on the original Scheduled date of tender opening, shall alone be taken into account.
- (xiv) Performance certificate/Work Completion Certificate issued by Consultant will not be considered.

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GENERAL MANAGER/ CONTRACTS